Prepared 7 November 2026 · every figure is computed from the rotas

New CEA link proposals — at a glance

All 22 proposals against today's link — the three shortlisted ones marked ★, and the ten where 14 days' leave buys 30 days off, as today, marked so — sorted by December rules met, then avoidable fatigue warnings, then by name; a proposal that breaks a hard limit cannot be run as it stands and comes last. Staffing levels and Sunday cover confirmed verbally (29 September 2026); the 26-line link, 5 cover weeks and a ceiling of 219 contracted days a year set on 1 October 2026.

PROPOSAL · CODE	DECEMBER RULES MET	AVOIDABLE FATIGUE WARNINGS§	MOST DAYS IN A ROW§	FULL WEEKENDS OFF	SHORTEST REST BETWEEN SHIFTS§	SHIFT TIMES	DAYS A YEAR*	HEAVIEST WEEK, MON–SAT	WEEKS ON ONE SHIFT TIME, ALL EARLIES OR ALL LATES	WEEKS MIXING EARLIES AND LATES	WEEK-TO-WEEK CHANGE OF START	FINISHES 23:00+ A YEAR†
Today's link 20 weeks	4 of 9	4 up to 5§	7 up to 9§	4 in 20 about 10 a year · 7 weeks apart at most	12h 30m	18	219.0	43h 50m	7 of 16 blocks 2 (up to 3)	7	4h 00m	39
Balanced V5 MB-26-V5 30 days off for 14 days' leave	9 of 9	0 up to 4§	5 up to 10§	6 in 26 about 12 a year · 6 weeks apart at most	13h 50m	16 (7 new)	218.6	42h 55m	7 of 21 blocks 3 (up to 5)	3	4h 06m	42
Balanced V6 MB-26-V6 30 days off for 14 days' leave	9 of 9	0 up to 4§	5 up to 10§	6 in 26 about 12 a year · 6 weeks apart at most	14h 20m	17 (8 new)	218.6	42h 55m	7 of 21 blocks 3 (up to 5)	3	4h 08m	42
Balanced V7 MB-26-V7 30 days off for 14 days' leave	9 of 9	0 up to 1§	5 up to 7§	7 in 26 about 14 a year · 5 weeks apart at most	14h 20m	17 (8 new)	218.6	42h 55m	13 of 21 blocks 3 (up to 5)	3	2h 33m	42
Clean Slate CS-26-N2	9 of 9	0 up to 1§	5 up to 7§	7 in 26 about 14 a year · 5 weeks apart at most	14h 35m	16 (10 new)	218.6	42h 00m	19 of 21 blocks 5 (up to 7)	0	1h 21m	42
Closing Time CT-26-T2	9 of 9	0 up to 1§	5 up to 7§	7 in 26 about 14 a year · 5 weeks apart at most	14h 35m	13 (5 new)	218.6	42h 00m	17 of 21 blocks 5 (up to 7)	0	1h 10m	42
Common Ground CG-26-T8 ★ shortlisted 30 days off for 14 days' leave	9 of 9	0 up to 1§	5 up to 7§	7 in 26 about 14 a year · 5 weeks apart at most	14h 35m	13 (6 new)	218.6	42h 30m	19 of 21 blocks 5 (up to 7)	0	1h 12m	42
Crossover CO-26-T10 30 days off for 14 days' leave	9 of 9	0 up to 0§	5 up to 6§	7 in 26 about 14 a year · 5 weeks apart at most	14h 20m	13 (6 new)	218.6	42h 30m	19 of 21 blocks 5 (up to 7)	0	1h 31m	42
Even Keel EK-26-H1	9 of 9	0 up to 1§	5 up to 7§	7 in 26 about 14 a year · 5 weeks apart at most	14h 35m	15 (7 new)	218.6	42h 00m	18 of 21 blocks 5 (up to 12)	1	1h 16m	44
Even Step ES-26-T5 ★ shortlisted	9 of 9	0 up to 1§	5 up to 7§	7 in 26 about 14 a year · 5 weeks apart at most	14h 35m	13 (5 new)	218.6	42h 00m	18 of 21 blocks 5 (up to 7)	0	1h 30m	42
Fair Share FS-26-T7	9 of 9	0 up to 1§	5 up to 7§	7 in 26 about 14 a year · 5 weeks apart at most	14h 35m	16 (8 new)	218.6	42h 00m	18 of 21 blocks 5 (up to 7)	0	1h 19m	42
Grand Tour GT-26-T7 30 days off for 14 days' leave	9 of 9	0 up to 1§	5 up to 7§	7 in 26 about 14 a year · 5 weeks apart at most	14h 35m	16 (8 new)	218.6	42h 00m	16 of 21 blocks 5 (up to 7)	0	1h 16m	42
Home Grown HG-26-T1	9 of 9	0 up to 1§	5 up to 7§	7 in 26 about 14 a year · 5 weeks apart at most	14h 35m	13 (3 new)	218.6	42h 30m	16 of 21 blocks 5 (up to 7)	0	1h 26m	42
In Step IS-26-T4	9 of 9	0 up to 1§	5 up to 7§	7 in 26 about 14 a year · 5 weeks apart at most	14h 35m	15 (6 new)	218.6	41h 05m	18 of 21 blocks 5 (up to 7)	0	1h 13m	42
Level Crossing LC-26-T10 30 days off for 14 days' leave	9 of 9	0 up to 0§	5 up to 6§	7 in 26 about 14 a year · 5 weeks apart at most	14h 20m	13 (6 new)	218.6	42h 30m	18 of 21 blocks 5 (up to 7)	0	1h 34m	42
Long Break LB-26-F1	9 of 9	0 up to 1§	6 up to 7§	7 in 26 about 14 a year · 5 weeks apart at most	14h 20m	15 (6 new)	218.6	42h 00m	16 of 21 blocks 5 (up to 9)	0	1h 44m	42
Middle Ground MG-26-T8 30 days off for 14 days' leave	9 of 9	0 up to 1§	5 up to 7§	7 in 26 about 14 a year · 5 weeks apart at most	14h 35m	13 (6 new)	218.6	42h 30m	18 of 21 blocks 5 (up to 7)	0	1h 42m	42
Next Step NS-26-T6	9 of 9	0 up to 1§	5 up to 7§	7 in 26 about 14 a year · 5 weeks apart at most	14h 35m	14 (6 new)	218.6	42h 00m	18 of 21 blocks 5 (up to 7)	0	1h 18m	42
Open Return OR-26-EXT 30 days off for 14 days' leave	9 of 9	0 up to 0§	5 up to 6§	7 in 26 about 14 a year · 5 weeks apart at most	13h 15m	16 (8 new)	218.6	43h 00m	18 of 21 blocks 5 (up to 7)	0	1h 17m	42
Second Edition SE-26-F1	9 of 9	0 up to 1§	6 up to 7§	7 in 26 about 14 a year · 5 weeks apart at most	14h 20m	15 (6 new)	218.6	42h 00m	18 of 21 blocks 5 (up to 7)	0	1h 01m	42
Second Look SL-26-G3	9 of 9	0 up to 0§	6 up to 6§	7 in 26 about 14 a year · 5 weeks apart at most	14h 20m	14 (6 new)	218.6	43h 40m	15 of 21 blocks 4 (up to 6)	1	1h 30m	42
Short Openers SO-26-EXT 30 days off for 14 days' leave	9 of 9	0 up to 0§	5 up to 6§	7 in 26 about 14 a year · 5 weeks apart at most	13h 15m	14 (6 new)	218.6	42h 00m	18 of 21 blocks 5 (up to 7)	0	1h 12m	42
Short Run SR-26-F1 ★ shortlisted	9 of 9	0 up to 1§	5 up to 7§	7 in 26 about 14 a year · 5 weeks apart at most	14h 20m	15 (6 new)	218.6	42h 30m	18 of 21 blocks 5 (up to 7)	0	1h 14m	42

* Monday to Saturday, with a cover week counted as 4 days (Sundays are overtime and left out). † Each person, on average across the whole link, Sundays included; cover-week duties are not known yet and are left out. "Shift times" counts different start–finish times; "new" means nobody works that time today.

"Weeks on one shift time" means one shift time Monday to Friday, all earlies or all lates; beneath it, the longest block of weeks in a row on one kind, "up to" if the cover weeks beside it go the same way. The week-to-week change is the average move of the start time from one week to the next.

§ On the duties the rota fixes, the cover weeks left out for the proposal and today alike; "up to" is the worst place a cover week's four duties could fall, its Sunday worked as overtime — for the 55-hour week, as 8-hour duties. Avoidable fatigue warnings come from the ORR's good-practice list plus rail-industry checks, leaving out the two that come with the station and the link — the 06:20 open and a weekly rotation — and are reported, never pass or fail.

Full detail for each proposal is in its own eight-page sheet; the rules themselves are in links-26-rules.pdf.